Preservation Recommendations

The preservation review conducted during this project focused on evaluating whether the dataset and supporting documentation are suitable for long-term access, interpretation, and future reuse. Although the dataset is hosted in a trusted scholarly repository, several improvements could strengthen preservation of both the files and the contextual understanding needed for reuse.

1. Expand Repository Documentation

One of the most important preservation improvements would be expanding the repository documentation. Long-term preservation is not only about storing files, but also about preserving the meaning and interpretability of the data over time.

Recommended additions include:

- clearer variable descriptions,
- expanded README documentation,
- methodological summaries,
- and explanations of file relationships.

This would help future researchers understand the dataset even if they are unfamiliar with the original study.

2. Create a Detailed Data Dictionary

The dataset would benefit from a structured data dictionary explaining:

- variable names,
- coded values,
- scoring methods,
- data types,
- and derived variables.

A detailed data dictionary would significantly improve long-term interpretability and reduce dependency on the associated publication.

3. Preserve Workflow and Transformation Information

The repository currently provides limited documentation about preprocessing, transformation, and analytical preparation steps. Preserving workflow-related information would improve transparency and future reproducibility.

Recommended preservation additions include:

- preprocessing notes,
- transformation explanations,
- workflow summaries,
- and version tracking information.

This would support stronger provenance and analytical lineage preservation.

4. Strengthen Standalone Interpretability

At present, meaningful interpretation of the dataset depends heavily on the associated journal article. Future preservation efforts should aim to make the repository more self-contained.

This could include:

- adding contextual explanations directly within repository materials,
- documenting study-specific terminology,
- and reducing reliance on external resources for interpretation.

Improving standalone interpretability would support more sustainable long-term reuse.

5. Maintain Open and Preservation-Friendly Formats

The dataset is currently stored in CSV format, which is suitable for long-term preservation because it is:

- non-proprietary,
- machine-readable,
- and widely supported across analytical platforms.

Future preservation efforts should continue prioritizing open and accessible formats to reduce risks associated with software obsolescence.